

## Trump: ‘We’ll own’ Gaza

Says US would rebuild battered land and relocate Palestinians

By Peter Baker, Michael D. Shear, and Isabel Kershner  
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — President Trump declared Tuesday he would seek to permanently displace the entire Palestinian population of the Gaza Strip and take over the devastated seaside enclave as a US territory, one of the most brazen ideas that any American leader has advanced in years.

Hosting Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu of Israel at the White

House, Trump said all 2 million Palestinians from Gaza should be moved to countries like Egypt and Jordan because of the devastation wrought by Israel’s war with Hamas after the terrorist attack of Oct. 7, 2023.

“The US will take over the Gaza Strip, and we will do a job with it too,” Trump said at an evening news conference. “We’ll own it and be responsible” for disposing of unexploded munitions and rebuilding Gaza into a mecca for jobs and tourism. Sounding like the

real estate developer he once was, he vowed to turn it into “the Riviera of the Middle East.”

While the president framed the matter as a humanitarian imperative and an economic development opportunity, he effectively reopened a geopolitical Pandora’s box with far-reaching implications for the Middle East. Control over Gaza has been one of the major flashpoints of the Arab-Israeli conflict going back decades, and the idea

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EVAN VUCCI/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu and President Trump met Tuesday. “He sees a different future for that piece of land,” Netanyahu said of Trump’s proposal for the United States to take over Gaza.

## ‘Intense’ push to fall in line on nominees

Cassidy, other holdouts were increasingly isolated

By Tal Kopan and Jim Puzzanghera  
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — Senator Bill Cassidy had just cast the decisive committee vote Tuesday to advance Robert F. Kennedy Jr.’s nomination as health secretary and the Louisiana Republican felt he had to go to the Senate floor to explain himself.

Normally, a senator’s vote for a nominee from the president of his own party wouldn’t require much justification. But Cassidy is a former physician who had publicly struggled with the nomination, particularly because of Kennedy’s years of outspoken antivaccine views. So Cassidy decided to detail how a flurry of behind-the-scenes talks over the weekend had moved him from skeptic to supporter.

“I’ve been contacted by text by phone by email. ... I was getting hundreds of messages a day personally and thousands through the office,” Cassidy said in his speech, describing a “long and tense process” that included multiple

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HAIYUN JIANG/NEW YORK TIMES

Senator Bill Cassidy described getting hundreds of messages.

## Executive orders work as ‘lawsuit bait,’ experts say

By Anjali Huynh  
GLOBE STAFF

President Trump entered office two weeks ago with a goal to shock and awe the country with sweeping changes built on his campaign promises. Dozens of executive orders later, many did just that — albeit, with more than a little chaos and a host of legal challenges.

The point is not necessarily to successfully implement all of these changes right away, legal experts told the Globe. Rather, his administration is also laying the groundwork for legal fights that could make their way to a conservative-dominated Supreme Court reshaped by his first term.

So far, a federal judge has blocked Trump’s attempt to ban birthright citizenship for children of some immigrants, after lawsuits nationwide asserted it violated the 14th Amendment. An effort last week to pause federal funding was met with criticism and uncertainty, prompting

Trump officials to walk back that move as it faced a court restraining order. And several groups representing federal employees have sued his administration over unprecedented efforts to roll back protections for civil servants.

Those actions amount to just a fraction of Trump’s moves in the first days of his term, many of which are more legally controversial than during his first. That’s called into question what Trump is allowed to do using presidential authority alone.

“It is overwhelming people so that anything that happens after this seems more moderate, only relative to these opening moves,” said Jed Shugerman, a Boston University presidential historian and legal expert. “Some of it’s strategic, some of it is negligent or reckless ... but Trump 2 is handling things differently than Trump 1, in that they seem to be going for the controversies.”

EXECUTIVE ORDERS, Page A6

### Trans treatment

The ACLU and others sued over an executive order seeking to sharply restrict access to gender transition treatments. **B1.**

### FBI agents file lawsuit

They are trying to block Justice from maintaining or releasing a list of those who worked on investigations tied to Trump. **A2.**

### Job cuts ahead?

A GSA official said layoffs across the federal government are “likely” after the deferred resignation offer expires. **B7.**



Josh Kraft entered the mayor’s race criticizing Mayor Michelle Wu. And she fired right back at him.



## Mayor’s race opens up with sharp rhetoric

Kraft officially taking on Wu to lead Boston

By Emma Platoff and Niki Griswold  
GLOBE STAFF

He criticized her work leading the city. She countered that he hasn’t spent much time living in it.

And with that, the race for Boston mayor kicked off Tuesday, not with a whimper, but with a snark-laced bang, as longtime nonprofit leader Josh Kraft officially launched his bid by lobbing attacks at incumbent Mayor Michelle Wu that she was quick to return.

“We have a mayor that just does not listen,” Kraft, the third son of billionaire Patriots owner Robert Kraft, said at his announcement Tuesday morning

in Dorchester. “Mayor Wu acts as if she alone has the answers.” He said the city faces “serious challenges” — “challenges Mayor Wu has not risen to.”

Wu, for her part, remarked at an unrelated event Tuesday afternoon, “I’m a little surprised that someone who’s never even voted for mayor or city councilor before in Boston feels like he’s ready to lead the city.”

“I welcome Josh Kraft to the city,” Wu said in a statement blasted out to reporters later in the day.

Kraft moved from Chestnut Hill to the North End only recently, registering to vote in Boston in fall 2023, though he had already spent three decades working at the Boys & Girls Club of Boston, including 12 years as its head.

Those opening salvos lay the groundwork for what’s likely to

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## Ski lift fear is real but is it warranted?

According to a report from the National Ski Areas Association, there have been

**14**

**fatalities**

stemming from mechanical malfunctions of lifts between 1973 and 2020. But the report states that only

**2 percent**

of falls are from mechanical or operator failure; 86 percent are blamed on “passenger behavior.”

After Attitash accident, a look at mountain safety

By Billy Baker  
GLOBE STAFF

It’s rare, you tell yourself as you board a ski lift. You have a better chance of being injured on the way down the hill. Or on the drive to the mountain. Or in the shower once you strip off your long johns.

But then your chair passes alongside a support tower, and the arm holding the chair to the cable rumbles as it goes over the little wheels, and your stomach drops, and it occurs to you that you are in a chair, in the sky, and it’s a long way down.

Fear of chairlifts is common in skiing. Accidents are not. But on Sunday, the unthinkable happened at Attitash Mountain Resort in Bartlett, N.H., when a man was injured after the chair he was riding on dislodged from the cable and fell 20 feet to the ground.

The man suffered a back injury, and the incident was blamed on “mechanical failure,” according to the State Fire Marshal’s Office, which is investigating the incident along with the state’s Passenger Tramway Safety Board. Attitash did not

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JONATHAN WIGGS/GLOBE STAFF/FILE/2021

Skiers rode a chairlift in Massachusetts. Fear of chairlifts is common in skiing. Accidents are not.

### Having our chill

**Wednesday:** Colder, some sun. High: 26-31. Low: 18-23.

**Thursday:** Snow, sleet. High: 34-39. Low: 33-38.

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VOL. 307, NO. 36

Suggested retail price \$4.00



About 10 people, including the gunman, were killed at an adult education center in what Sweden’s prime minister called the country’s worst mass shooting. **A3.**

A Somerville artist whose work was taken from a gallery last month says his stolen art was delivered back to him over the weekend. **B1.**

The embattled head of Saint Vincent Hospital in Worcester is resigning, after running the hospital during the longest nursing strike in state history and facing accusations of mismanagement by nurses. **B5.**

At PopUp Bagels’ new location in the Seaport, there will be gripping, ripping, and dipping. And probably waiting, writes Devra First. **G1.**

